

MSI	MSI
K9N2 SLI Platinum	K9N2 Diamond
Rs. 7,500	Rs. 9,500
66.01	66.23
39.44	40.99
26.57	25.24
AMD 750a SLI	NVIDIA 780a SLI
AM2+	AM2+
750a SLI	780a SLI
DDR2	DDR2
8 GB / 4	8 GB / 4
6 / 2	6 / 2
Y / 2	Y / 2
2	3
2 / 1 / 0	2 / 1 / 0
Y / 2	Y / 3
Realtek ALC888	Creative SB X-Fi Xtreme
8	8
N / Y	N / N
1 / Gigabit	2 / Gigabit
N	N
4 / 1	4 / 1
Y	Y
1.45 ~ 1.8	Default ~ 1.8
0.025	0.025
1.9 ~ 2.4	1.8 ~ 2.5
0.05	0.05
8	7
7.5	7
8	8
8	8
4 / 2	6 / 1
Dvi-to-HDMI converter, USB/Firewire bracket, SLI bridge,	X-Fi Extreme Audio card, USB/Firewire bracket
10258	10273
6228	6236
20022	14710
8808	8627
12306	9985
9584	9795
36475	35818
7056	6912
8838	8659
11054	10998
2251	2393
30	30
171	166
194	233
78	79
68	71
44	43

Performance

For boards with onboard graphics solutions, the performance can be a concern for some. The boards available for AMD processors have

Integrated Graphics Core 2 Duo Boards				
Brand	Biostar	ECS	Jetway	MSI
Model No.	G41D-M7	G41T-M2	I43GM1-HG	G43M2
Price (Rupees)	Rs. 2,800	Rs. 3,585	Rs. 3,300	Rs. 6,400
Overall (Out of 100)	44.73	44.62	53.89	44.15
Features (Out of 70)	19.86	19.04	28.26	18.45
Performance (Out of 30)	24.87	25.58	25.63	25.70
Features				
Chipset	Intel G41	Intel G41	Intel G43	Intel G43
Socket	LGA775	LGA775	LGA775	LGA775
Northbridge / Southbridge	G41 / ICH7	G41 / ICH7	G43 / ICH10	G43 / ICH10
Memory Type	DDR2	DDR2	DDR2	DDR2
Max Memory Supported (GB) / No of DIMMs	8 GB / 2	8 GB / 2	8 GB / 2	4 GB / 2
No. of SATA / IDE Ports	4 / 1	4 / 2	6 / 0	4 / 1
E-SATA Support / No of E-SATA Ports	N / 0	N / 0	N / 0	N / 0
No of PCI Express x16 graphics slots	1	1	1	1
No. of PCI / PCI x1 / PCI x4 Slots	1 / 0 / 0	1 / 2 / 0	1 / 0 / 0	2 / 1 / 0
Multi GPU Support (SLI/CrossFire/N) / No of PCIe Lanes	N	N	N	N
Integrated Audio Controller	Realtek ALC662	Realtek ALC662	Realtek ALC888	Realtek ALC888
Number of Sound channels	6	6	8	8
SPDIF / Optical Port	N / N	N / N	Y / N	N / N
No of LAN Ports / 10/100 / Gigabit	1 / Gigabit	1 / Gigabit	1 / Gigabit	1 / Gigabit
Integrated Wi-Fi (Y/N)	N	N	N	N
No. of rear USB / FireWire Ports	4 / 0	4 / 0	4 / 0	4 / 1
All Solid State Caps (Y/N)	N	N	N	N
BIOS options				
CPU voltage range (volts)	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
CPU Voltage increments	N/A	N/A	0.05	N/A
Memory voltage range (volts)	NA	N/A	1.85 ~ 3.285	N/A
Memory Voltage increments	0.1	N/A	0.03	N/A
Board Layout (So 10)				
Region around the CPU	8	8	8	7.5
Location of SATA ports	7.5	7.5	8	8
Placement of Memory modules	7.5	7.5	8	8
Graphics card slot and PCI slots	6.5	7	7.5	7
Package Bundle				
No of SATA / PATA Cables Provided	1 / 1	1 / 1	2 / 0	1 / 1
Accessories	-	-	-	-
Performance				
PC Mark 05				
CPU	9575	9573	9636	9658
Memory	6037	6091	6235	6280
Graphics	3283	3405	2750	2705
HDD	8714	9923	8824	8835
Overall	7681	7727	6686	6686
ScienceMark (Memory Bandwidth)	5691	5798	6050	6012
CINEBENCH R10 (CPU)	11778	11658	11393	11750
WinRAR 3.8	1818	2086	2124	2063
DivX Video Encoding (100 MB VOB) (sec)	32	31	31	31
Sequential File Transfer Test (8 GB File) (sec)	180	163	172	179
Random File Transfer Test (8 GB File) (sec)	194	193	210	193
Doom 3 FPS (800 x 600, medium detail)	18.1	19.4	17.5	17.4
3D Mark 2006 (CPU / Overall)	3961 / 854	4036 / 855	4015 / 1142	4134 / 1130
Company Of Heroes (1024 x 768, lowest)	23.03	22.6	26.9	28.2

rather respectable scores across all fields. They also have the advantage of being cheaper than equally well performing boards for the Intel platform which is why in general AMD based systems are suggest for those who are on a really tiny budget. We see a new trend this time around where AMD 785 boards leave the older AMD 780 behind.

Some of the boost is from the game benchmarks while the biggest contribution comes from memory benchmarks and file compression benchmarks. The ASUS M4A785TD-V EVO leads the charts overall for sheer performance. NVIDIA hasn't released any more AMD chipsets in the meantime. The GeForce 8200 boards from Jetway and ZOTAC present

a similar. With dropping prices, these boards along with the older AMD 780G although slightly slower in graphics benchmarks are comparable with the rest of the benchmarks. Prices too are much lower than better performing AMD 785G boards.

So, what's the best?

We have a clear leader in every